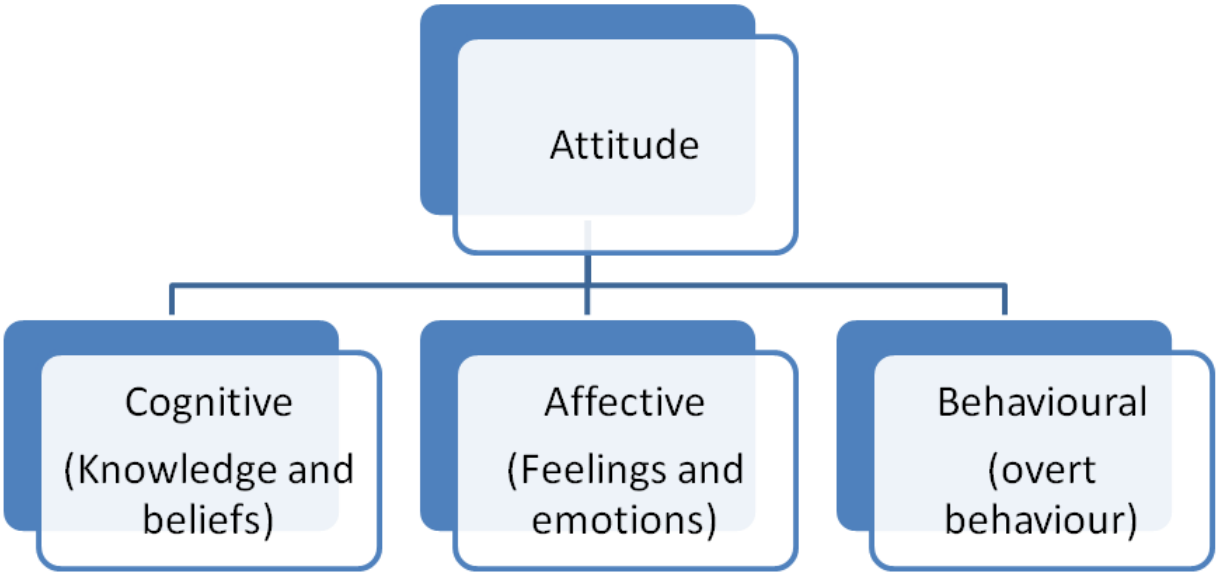
Organizational Behavior

Chapter: 03. Attitudes and Job Satisfaction

Attitudes

Evaluative statements or judgments concerning objects, people, or events. An attitude is a mental and neural state of readiness, organized through experience, exerting a directive or dynamic influence upon the individual's response to all objects and situations with which it is related. An attitude is a positive; negative or mixed evaluation of an object that is expressed at some level of intensity. It is an expression of a favorable or unfavorable evaluation of a person, place, thing or event. Attitudes involve a complex organization of evaluative beliefs, feelings, and tendencies toward certain actions.

Components of Attitude



1. Cognitive Component

The cognitive component of attitudes refers to the beliefs, thoughts, and attributes that we would associate with an object. It refers to that part of attitude which is related in general knowledge of a person.

- It is the opinion or belief segment of an attitude.
- It is the thoughts about an attitude.
- For example: People who are scared of spider, they justify their actions against the spider, believing it to be dangerous in some way.

2. Affective Component

This involves a person's feelings / emotions about the attitude object. It is related to the statement which affects another person. It deals with feelings or emotions that are brought to the surface about something, such as fear or hate.

- It is the emotional or feeling segment of an attitude.
- For example: A person say I don't like spider because it is dangerous.

3. Behavioral Component

An intention to behave in a certain way toward someone or something. Behavior component of an attitude consists of a person's tendencies to behave 'in a particular way toward an object. It refers to that part of attitude which reflects the intention of a person in the short-run or long run.

- It reflects the intention to behave in certain ways.
- It is the predispositions to act towards an attitude.
- For example: If the person scared of spiders sees one, they will react and scream.

Moderating Variables

The most powerful moderators of the attitude-behavior relationship are:

- Importance of the attitude
- Correspondence to behavior
- Accessibility
- Existence of social pressures
- Personal and direct experience of the attitude

Major Job Attitudes

1. Job Satisfaction: The term job satisfaction describes a positive feeling about a job, resulting from an evaluation of its characteristics. A person with a high level of job satisfaction holds positive feeling about his or her job, while a dissatisfied person holds negative feelings. When people speak of employee attitudes, they usually mean job satisfaction.

2. Job Involvement: Related to job satisfaction is job involvement. Job involvement measures the degree to which people identify psychologically with their job and consider their perceived performance level important to self-worth.

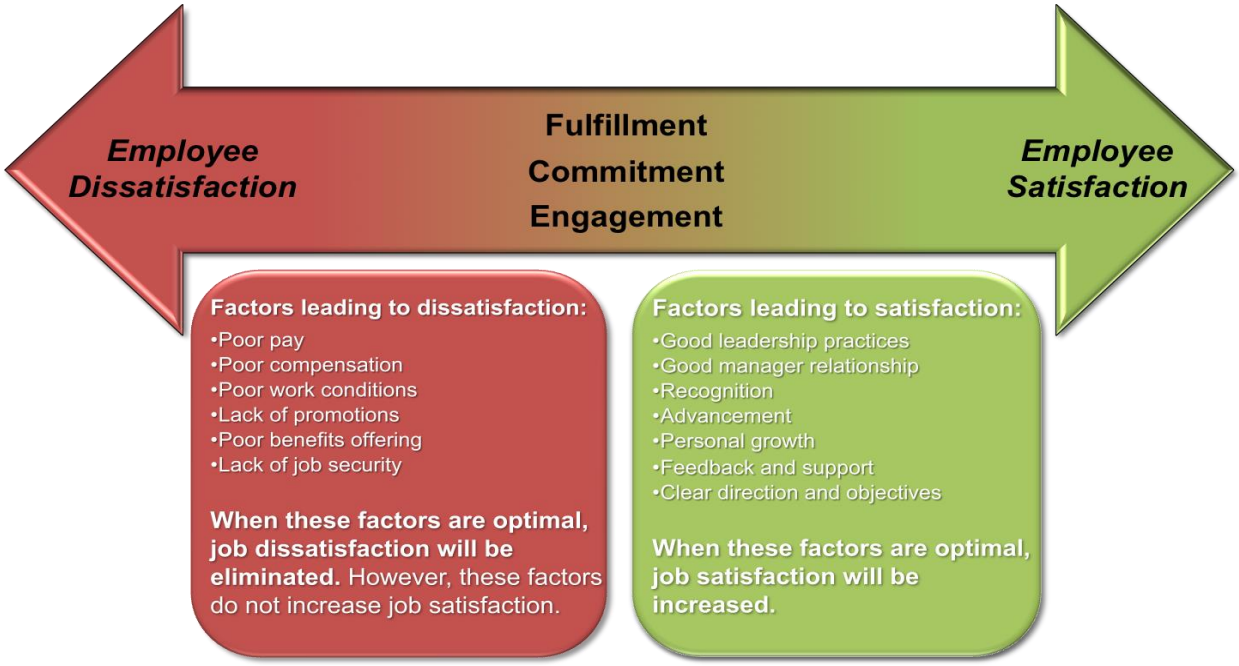
3. Organizational Commitment: A state in which an employee identifies with a particular organization and its goals and wishes to maintain membership in the organization. So, high job involvement means identifying with your specific job, while high organizational commitment means identifying with your employing organization.

4. Psychological Empowerment: Another closely related concept is psychological empowerment, which is employees' beliefs in the degree to which they influence their work environment, their competence, the meaningfulness of their job, and the perceived autonomy in their work.

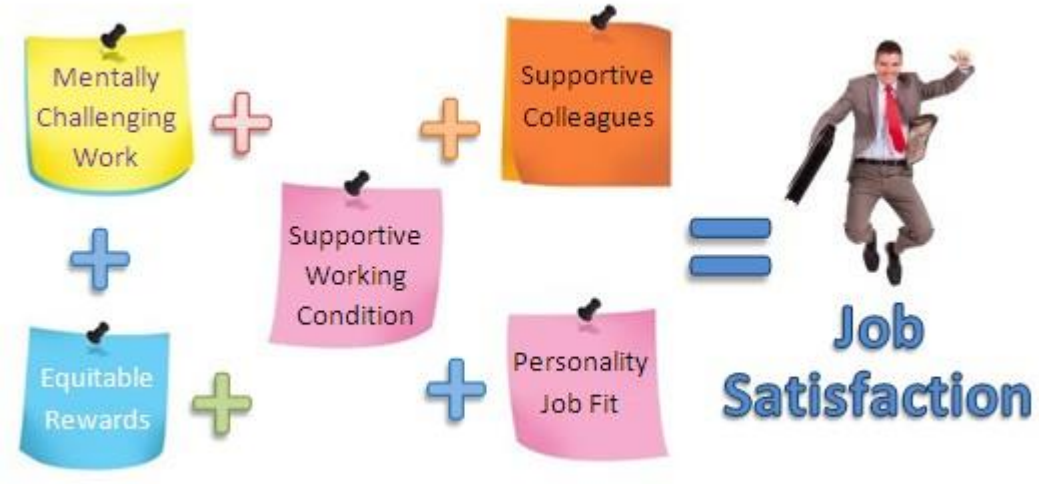
5. Employee Engagement: An individual's involvement with, satisfaction with, and enthusiasm for the work he or she does. Engaged employees are passionate about their work and company. Highly engaged employees have a passion for their work and feel a deep connection to their company; disengaged employees have essentially "checked out" – putting time but not energy or attention into their work.

6. Perceived Organizational Support: Degree to which employees believe the organization values their contribution and cares about their well-being. Higher when rewards are fair, employees are involved in decision-making, and supervisors are seen as supportive. High perceived organizational support is related to higher organizational citizenship behaviors and performance.

Job Satisfaction Model



Causes of Job Satisfaction



1. Company Policies: Policies that are transparent, fair and applied equally to all employees will decrease dissatisfaction. Therefore, fairness and clarity are crucial in improving employee attitude. For example, if a company has a policy for lunch breaks having the same length and time for all, it will be seen as a norm and will help cut down on wasted time and low productivity.

2. Salary/Benefits: Making sure employee salaries and benefits are comparable to other organization salaries and benefits will help raise satisfaction. If a company wishes to produce a competitive product they must also offer competitive wages. Furthermore, this can help reduce turnover, as employees will invariably be more satisfied when paid competitive wages as opposed to being underpaid.

3. Interpersonal/Social Relations: Encouraging employees to develop a social aspect to their job may increase satisfaction as well as develop a sense of teamwork. Co-worker relationships will benefit the organization as a whole since teamwork is a very important aspect of organization productivity and success. Moreover, when people are allowed to develop work relationships they care more about pulling their own weight and not letting co-workers down. Employee involvement groups are a great way to help employees interact with individuals outside their department or organization.

4. Working Conditions: Upgrading facilities and equipment and ensuring employees have adequate personal workspace can decrease dissatisfaction. A cramped employee is a frustrated employee plus faulty equipment leads to frustration in trying to get work done.

5. Achievement: Ensuring employees are appropriately placed to utilize their talents may enhance satisfaction. When employees are given proper role and feel a sense of achievement and challenge, their talents will be in line with the goals best suited for them.

6. Recognition: Ensuring a job well done is duly acknowledged increases the likelihood of employee satisfaction. Positive and constructive feedback boosts an employee's morale and helps them work at the desired level and towards the desired direction.

7. Autonomy: Giving employees the freedom and sense of ownership of their work may help raise job satisfaction as the individuals realize they are responsible for the outcome of their work.

8. Advancement: Allowing employees showing high performance and loyalty, the room to advance will help ensure satisfaction. A new / higher position and sense of responsibility can often increase job satisfaction in an employee.

9. Job Security: Especially in times of economic uncertainty, job security is a very crucial factor in determining an employee's job satisfaction. Giving an employee the assurance that their job is secure will most likely increase job satisfaction.

10. Work-life Balance Practices: In times where the average household is changing, it is becoming increasingly important for an employer to recognize the delicate balancing act that its employees perform between their personal life and work life. Policies that cater to common personal and family needs can be essential to maintaining job satisfaction.

Outcomes of Job Satisfaction

1. Job Performance: Satisfied workers are more productive and more productive workers are more satisfied. If people receive rewards which have both intrinsic and extrinsic value and they feel that these rewards are equitable, they will be satisfied and this will lead to greater job performance.

2. Organizational Citizenship Behaviors: Satisfaction influence organizational citizenship behaviors through perceptions of fairness.

3. Customer Satisfaction: Satisfied frontline employees increase customer satisfaction and also enhance loyalty among the customers.

4. Absenteeism: Satisfied employees are moderately less likely to miss work. It has been conclusively proved that there is an inverse relationship between job satisfaction and absenteeism. When satisfaction is high, absenteeism is low and when satisfaction is low, absenteeism is high. Less satisfied employees are more likely to be absent from work due to avoidable reasons.

5. Turnover: Satisfied employees are less likely to quit. Many moderating variables in this relationship like: economic environment and tenure, organizational actions taken to retain high performance and tend to weed out lower performers. High employee turnover is a matter of concern for the management as it disrupts the normal operations and continuous replacement of employees who leave the organization is costly and technically undesirable.